Civilian Duties, Police Costs and a Funded Handoff

For Police, HSSD, Personnel, Finance and Council budget staff
David L. Condrey · Independent; self-funded · October 18, 2026
SDHA-2026-01-E · Version 1.0 · Based on SDHA-2026-01 v1.3

Adopt public cost comparison → **Separate funding and readiness decision**

The existing wider SDPD civilianization proposal was estimated to add about **$17.6 million** without an expected spending or overtime reduction, demonstrating why a transfer cannot be assumed to save money. [BK22] [BK23]

For the narrower duties considered here, the decision is whether added civilian capability justifies its full net cost. The comparison must identify the eligible work, the receiving team and the Police coverage that remains.

> **Principal request:** Produce one priced comparison of eligible duties, retained police coverage and replacement costs within a proposed 60-day period, followed by a separate funded readiness decision before any transfer.

Responsible lead: The HSSD Director coordinates the comparison; Police, Personnel and Finance supply task, classification and marginal-cost evidence.

> **Fiscal boundary:** Released capacity is not cash, civilian transfer creates no shelter beds by itself, and the full report's $2.2 million comparison ceiling is illustrative—not a verified transferable Police balance.

Current recommendation: Retain current assignments while pricing coordination improvements, eligible civilian duties and placement/access investment on the same service and full-cost basis. Select a transfer only when its funded capability justifies the change.

Agency key: HSSD: City Homelessness Strategies and Solutions Department; SDPD: San Diego Police Department; HOT: Homeless Outreach Team.

SDPD civilianization staff report [BK22] · original pp. 1–2
SDPD civilianization presentation [BK23] · original pp. 8, 10

Full-report pp. 2, 58, 68, 69. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

The HOT inventory is a cost boundary, not a transfer amount.

$5,163,800

Police Homeless Outreach Team in the FY2027 homelessness outreach inventory; source thousands converted to dollars.

The inventory places HOT at **52.3%** of the reported **$9.869 million Outreach subtotal**. This identifies a substantial fiscal category to examine. It does not identify the share attributable to eligible tasks or show that the allocation is inappropriate. [FPB02] [FPB02]

Cost question	Evidence needed for this decision
Which work is eligible?	Actual task volume and paid time, with necessary police powers and retained safety coverage separated.
Which paid costs end?	Specific overtime, positions or other expenses that cease; redeployed time remains paid capacity.
What replaces the work?	Qualified staffing, supervision, clinical scope, receiving services, vehicles, transition and backfill.
What is the net effect?	First-year and recurring ending costs less full replacement costs, using lawful funds and actual implementation dates.

Existing civilian ESD crews and clinical/County outreach partners already perform part of this work. Their functions cannot be counted as newly transferred Police duties or omitted from the replacement-cost comparison. [S03]

> **Decision consequence:** Finance should reconcile the inventory to the tasks and paid costs actually affected. Council can commission that comparison without treating the HOT total as available financing or authorizing a transfer.

The wider civilianization estimate discussed on the opening page and this HOT inventory describe different scopes. Neither is a priced estimate of the narrower transfer proposed here.

IBA homelessness funding inventory [FPB02] · original pp. 1, 5, 7; source thousands converted to dollars
IBA homelessness funding inventory [FPB02] · original pp. 4–5, 7
IBA Police budget analysis [S03] · original p. 61; HOT partnership

Full-report pp. 2, 68, 69. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

Price eligible tasks and preserve the work that remains.

Candidate work	What the comparison must price
Intake, routing and updates	Eligible volume, paid time, supervision and escalation.
Voluntary placement and basic transport	Confirmed admission, consent, qualified staff, vehicles, insurance and backfill.
Outreach and follow-through	Additional provider scope beyond existing clinical and civilian delivery.

Necessary police powers, investigative judgment, required sworn attestations and unresolved immediate-safety duties remain outside the proposed civilian eligibility test; existing civilian work cannot be counted as a new transfer. [V15] [V15] [V15] [S03]

Identify the work before assigning its cost.

Training Bulletin 25-01 changed labels and overtime eligibility while retaining some order numbers; home unit alone can misclassify shared work. Preserve working or controlling command and native order identifiers. [BK06]

Actual work →	Pay category →	Cost object →	Ending paid cost

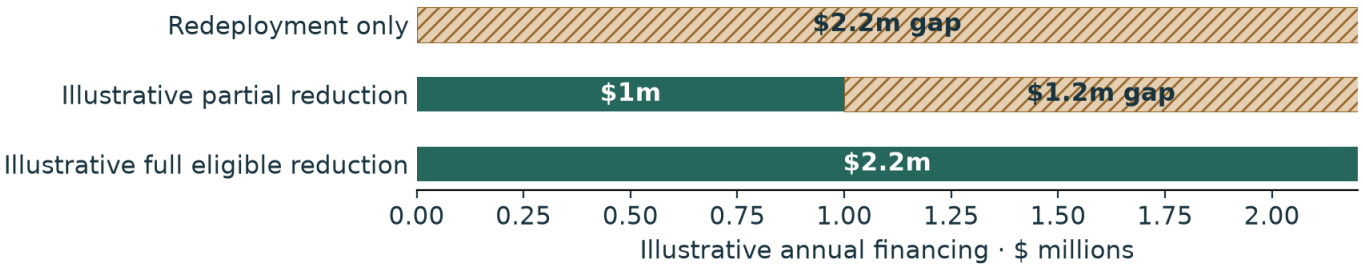
The bulletin identifies orders 11003903 for NPD General Fund and 11004334 for CleanSD as starting points, not proof of reducible HOT work; 11003715 is not a dedicated Get It Done code.

> **Limit:** The investigation did not acquire a matched task-to-payroll chain establishing transferable savings.

Police neighborhood operations manual [V15] · original p. 27; abatement roles
Police neighborhood operations manual [V15] · original p. 21; NPT Sergeant duties
Police neighborhood operations manual [V15] · original pp. 18–19, 25–27
IBA Police budget analysis [S03] · original p. 61; HOT partnership
Police order-code bulletin [BK06] · original pp. 1–5, 9–10

Full-report pp. 56, 68. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

No verified paid reduction funds the $2.2 million model.



Illustrative component	Annual comparison ceiling
Civilian desk / review / reserve	$700,000
Added qualified provider scope	$250,000
Housing assistance	$500,000
Sanitation access / servicing	$750,000
Total	**$2,200,000**

With no verified paid reduction, the model leaves the entire **$2.2 million unfunded**; even an assumed $1 million reduction leaves $1.2 million before additional transition or backfill costs.

The desk staffing screen uses October 2025 compensation: four support specialists and one analyst produce a **$664,393 first-year screen** and **$584,393 recurring screen**, with renewed review unpriced. Those are historical planning inputs, not current quotes. [BK23]

At assumed ten-minute jobs and 1,600 productive hours per specialist, the desk models 38,400 jobs annually versus 43,758 raw Get It Done reports; neither the sworn share nor actual handling time was measured. [GID26]

> **Apply the comparison:** Finance must show spending that actually ends, less replacement, transition and backfill costs, separately for the first year and recurring years.

SDPD civilianization presentation [BK23] · original pp. 1, 10; presentation date and total compensation
Get It Done captured aggregate [GID26] · FY2026 request aggregate and method; reports, not people

Full-report pp. 69, 80. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

Lower staffing cost can also mean less processing capacity.

The desk screen uses October 2025 total compensation and assumed operations, startup and review costs. Its first-year comparison changes materially when compensation rises. These are reproducible planning cases, not measured productivity or authorized staffing. [BK23]

Illustrative staffing case	Desk + review, first year	Modeled jobs/year
4 specialists + analyst; base	$664,393	38,400
Same staff; +25% compensation	$804,241.25	38,400
3 specialists + analyst; +25%	$673,863.75	28,800

The higher-compensation five-person case exceeds the **$700,000** allocation. Reducing specialist staffing brings the case within that boundary but also reduces modeled throughput. It does not make the same workload disappear.

The processing assumption is **ten minutes per job** and **1,600 productive hours per specialist**. Four specialists yield **38,400 jobs**, below **43,758** raw FY2026 Get It Done reports. Excluding all **13,257** parent-linked reports yields **30,501**; that is a sensitivity, not a rule that those reports require no work. [GID26]

Cost and workload boundaries: These cases exclude the full outreach model and reserve; renewed review is unpriced. Reports are not people, eligible duties or measured processing jobs. Non-Get It Done work and retained Police coverage also need pricing.

Decision consequence: Require current compensation, measured eligible task volume and handling time in the priced comparison. Approve a staffing level only when both the funded cost and the required service capacity are supported.

SDPD civilianization presentation [BK23] · original pp. 1, 10; presentation date and total compensation
Get It Done captured aggregate [GID26] · FY2026 request aggregate and method; reports, not people

Full-report pp. 69, 80. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

Below-budget spending coexists with missed response goals.

Verified budget variance

FY2026 Police General Fund actual expenditure was **$699,569,129**, below the **$703,515,478** adopted budget by **$3,946,349**. A favorable budget variance does not identify a current transferable cash balance. [BK08]

Service coverage constraints

The published FY2026 response-time indicators also miss stated goals: Priority 1 is 39.50 minutes against 14, and Priority 2 is 120 against 27. Necessary response coverage must be preserved. [S08]

The audit documents improved administrative response and useful storage practices, while existing outreach includes clinical partners; those gains should not disappear from the comparison. [S01] [S03]

Constraint	Consequence
Restricted or committed funds	No unrestricted financing credit without eligibility and obligation checks.
Fixed liabilities	No automatic savings from reallocating pension or other fixed-cost charges.
Existing vacancy savings	No second credit for savings already embedded in the adopted budget.
Work still required	Include supervision, retained coverage and paid backfill.

> **Final disposition:** A priced comparison is justified; a savings amount, superior civilian outcome or ready-to-launch transfer is not established.

City year-end financial report [BK08] · original pp. 36, 46
Adopted Police budget [S08] · original p. 5
City encampment-response audit [S01] · original p. 42 / printed p. 37
IBA Police budget analysis [S03] · original p. 61; HOT partnership

Full-report pp. 56, 58, 68, 69. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.

Two decisions, six gates and independent certifications.

Planning clock **Council adoption →**	**Proposed 60-day return** **Priced duty comparison →**	**Separate decision** **Itemized funding + readiness**

Readiness gate	Required evidence
Finance	Lawful resources, ending paid costs and full replacement/transition/backfill costs.
Task and safety coverage	Retained police duties, tested escalation and no uncovered essential function.
Qualified replacement	Staffing, supervision, credentials and confirmed receiving services.
Employment and contracts	Classification, labor, procurement and contract approvals.
Data and participant protection	Permissions, minimal information and an independent complaint route.
Measurement and review	Baseline, definitions, thresholds and funded independent review.

Zero affected duties or funds transfer until all six gates are met and the CFO, Police Chief and HSSD Director independently sign and publish evidence-backed readiness certifications.

Operating clock **Separately approved launch →**	**Proposed independent review** **Launch +180 days**

Preserve assistance during any pause. The operating clock starts at launch; the planning clock starts at adoption.

The full report's Appendix A supplies proposed Council clauses and `Evidence.zip` preserves the editable model and readiness forms; original contributions are CC BY 4.0, with third-party rights retained.

Decision rule: Retain assignments when eligibility, receiving capacity or lawful financing fails. Revise a proposal whose scope or coverage cannot be supported. Approve only a separately funded alternative that meets every gate; any higher cost needs an explicit service benefit and funding decision. Released hours remain a capacity result unless a paid obligation ends.

Full-report pp. 72, 77, 78. · Full report and evidence; select version 1.3.